G Grit + Grace Doula

FREE FAMILY EDUCATION · GUIDE 02

Ready for Baby

Hospital Bag & Birth-Day Preparation

A calm, practical plan for packing, travel, birth-day logistics, and the first trip home.

Printable workbook · US Letter

GUIDE 02 · 01

A little preparation, a little more room to breathe

You do not need to pack for every possibility. A short, shared plan can make departure day feel more manageable. Ask your hospital or birth center what it supplies, what it restricts, and how to contact the unit.

Use this as a starting point

Facility rules, labor plans, weather, travel distance, and personal needs differ. Confirm clinical and logistical questions with your care team and birth location.

Several weeks before

Confirm where to go, how to reach the unit, parking or drop-off details, and any registration steps.

A few weeks before

Gather documents, wash preferred clothing, and check what the facility provides.

When the bag is ready

Keep it in an easy-to-reach place and tell your support person where it is.

Before leaving

Use the departure checklist, secure the home, and follow your care team's instructions about when to call or travel.

A NOTE FROM TEESEE

A Note from Teesee: Preparation can support a sense of steadiness, even when plans need to change. Choose the items that matter most to your family.

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Birthing parent's bag

Checklist

- [ ] Photo identification and insurance or registration information, if requested
- [ ] Comfortable going-home clothes and a loose change of clothing
- [ ] Non-slip socks or slippers, if allowed
- [ ] Toiletries and personal care items
- [ ] Glasses, contacts, chargers, and any personal essentials
- [ ] Preferred pillow or comfort item in a distinct pillowcase
- [ ] A water bottle or snacks if permitted
- [ ] Any clinician-directed medicines in their original packaging, after checking facility policy

Packing tracker

Item	Packed
Still needed	Where it is

Check first

Ask the facility about medications, food, electrical items, pillows, and any restrictions. Do not stop or change prescribed medicines based on this list.

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Baby and support-person essentials

Baby

- Going-home outfit in a suitable size
- Weather-appropriate layer and blanket for carrying (not for sleep in the car seat)
- Installed, correctly sized car seat; ask a certified child passenger safety technician if you need help
- A small number of diapers or outfit changes, if not supplied

Support person

- Phone, charger, and important contacts
- Change of clothes and basic toiletries
- Food, water, and any personal medicines
- Parking information, payment method, and a plan for breaks

What the facility provides

Item to ask about	Facility answer
Bring it?	Follow-up

A rear-facing car seat is used for travel according to its manufacturer and local law. The car seat is for travel, not routine sleep after arrival home.

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Documents, travel, and birth-day logistics

Transportation plan

Primary driver and phone	Backup ride
Route and alternate route	Parking or drop-off instructions
Who will meet us	Pet or child-care plan

Contact directory

Birth location and unit phone	Primary care clinician
Support person	Backup support person
Childcare or pet-care contact	Other important contact

Checklist

- ☐ Confirm registration or pre-admission instructions
- ☐ Know the entrance to use at different hours
- ☐ Review when and how your care team wants you to call
- ☐ Charge phones and share the plan with the driver
- ☐ Check local weather and allow time for traffic

> **Plan for a change**
>
> If urgent symptoms arise, follow your clinician's instructions or contact emergency services. Do not delay urgent care to finish packing.

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Homecoming and final readiness

Checklist

- ☐ Prepare a safe sleep space that meets current pediatric guidance
- ☐ Wash a few baby clothes and set out a simple changing area
- ☐ Stock easy food and drinking water
- ☐ Arrange help for a household task or older child, if useful
- ☐ Keep care-team, pediatric, and pharmacy contacts accessible
- ☐ Install and check the car seat before birth when possible

Departure checklist

Call the birth location as instructed	Bag and documents
Driver and car seat	Home/child/pet plan
Phones and chargers	Final item to remember

Reflection

What would help you feel prepared enough, even if the day does not follow the plan?

Optional reflection · Philippians 4:6–7

A reference for families who welcome Christian encouragement; preparation is not a promise that every concern will disappear.

Sources and further reading

Prenatal care
American College of Obstetricians and Gynecologists

Hospital bag checklist
Office on Women's Health

Safe sleep for babies
American Academy of Pediatrics / HealthyChildren.org